



ELECTRICIAN

JOB DESCRIPTION

Electricians install and repair electrical equipment, such as power circuits, lighting, switches, and other fittings. Most work on site, visiting homes, shops, offices, and factories. Others train in specialized areas, such as street lighting, high-voltage systems used to transmit electricity over long distances, or the electrical wiring that supplies power to heavy industries.



SALARY

Trainee electrician ★★★★★

Experienced electrician ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Wide variety of employment options • Self-employment is common • Salaries can vary considerably depending on specialty and experience

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Electronics • Mathematics • Physics • Engineering • Information Technology (IT) • Buildings and maintenance



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no set requirements, but employers who offer apprenticeships often look for candidates with a high-school diploma.



LIFESTYLE Most electricians have regular hours, but may have to work evenings or weekends, or be on call for emergency repairs.



LOCATION Electricians work on site in a variety of settings, such as homes, factories, or shops.



THE REALITIES The job can involve working in cramped or dirty spaces. Keeping track of changing building regulations can be challenging.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **ELECTRICAL ENGINEER** *see pp. 186–187*
- ▶ **DOMESTIC APPLIANCE ENGINEER** Installs and repairs appliances, such as washing machines, electric cooking ranges, and fridges in homes.
- ▶ **ENERGY ENGINEER** Develops new methods of extracting energy from existing methods, such as electricity, nuclear power plants, and wind turbines.
- ▶ **KITCHEN FITTER** Installs kitchen interiors, including counters and cabinets, following designs and layouts accurately to achieve the look requested by the customer.
- ▶ **RAILROAD TECHNICIAN** Fits and maintains control panels, tracks, power lines, and other electrical equipment used on railroads.

Most electricians qualify through an apprenticeship or training program.